IMPORTANT PERSONALITIES OF MUMBAI AND MODERN INDIA

Grade 8 ICSE Social Studies (Mumbai) | Notes + Comparative Table + Practice Questions

1. QUICK REVISION NOTES

1. Jamsetji Nusserwanji Tata (1839–1904) – Father of Indian Industry

- Graduated from Elphinstone College, Mumbai (1858); founded a trading firm in 1868 and converted an oil mill at Chinchpokli, Mumbai (1869) into the Alexandra cotton mill, later establishing Bombay's Swadeshi Mill.
- Opened the Taj Mahal Hotel at Colaba waterfront, Mumbai (3 December 1903, first in India with electricity) and laid foundations for Tata Steel, IISc Bengaluru, and Tata Power.

2. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule (1827–1890) – Pioneer of Social Equality

- Social reformer and writer in Maharashtra who championed equal rights for marginalized communities, farmers, mill workers, and women (Britannica).
- Founded the Satyashodhak Samaj (Society of Truth Seekers) in 1873 to promote social justice without priestly intermediaries.

3. Savitribai Phule (1831–1897) – Pioneer of Women's Education in Maharashtra

- Regarded as India's first female teacher; worked alongside Jyotirao Phule to open indigenous schools for girls (starting in 1848) and shelter destitute widows (Britannica).

4. Dr. Bhimrao Ramji Ambedkar (1891–1956) – Architect of the Indian Constitution

- Jurist, economist, and reformer (Britannica) whose Mumbai residence, Rajgriha (Dadar), anchored his civic and educational movements; chaired the Drafting Committee of the Constituent Assembly of India.

5. Raja Ram Mohan Roy (1772–1833) – Father of the Indian Renaissance

- Founded the Brahmo Sabha in 1828 (precursor to Brahmo Samaj), inspiring Bombay's Prarthana Samaj; campaigned for the Abolition of Sati (1829) and modern scientific education (Britannica).

2. COMPARATIVE TABLE – EASY TO REMEMBER

Feature	Jamsetji Tata	Jyotirao Phule	Savitribai Phule	Dr. B. R. Ambedkar	R. R. M. Roy
Role / Title	Father of Indian Industry	Mahatma; Anti-caste reformer	Pioneer female educator	Architect of Constitution	Father of Indian Renaissance
Key Institution	Tata Group (1868); Taj Hotel	Satyashodhak Samaj (1873)	Girls' schools (1848)	Drafting Committee (1947)	Brahmo Sabha (1828)
Mumbai / West Link	Elphinstone College; Colaba	Maharashtra social reform	Maharashtra girls' schools	Rajgriha (Dadar, Mumbai)	Inspired Prarthana Samaj
Core Impact	Steel, power & hospitality	Upliftment of oppressed	Women's literacy & rights	Abolition of untouchability	Abolition of Sati (1829)

3. PRACTICE QUESTIONS & ANSWER KEY

Q1. Which Mumbai hotel opened on 3 December 1903 as India's first with electricity? — Ans: The Taj Mahal Hotel at Colaba waterfront, founded by Jamsetji Tata.

Q2. Which society was founded in 1873 by Jyotirao Phule and supported by Savitribai Phule? — Ans: The Satyashodhak Samaj (Society of Truth Seekers).

Q3. Name the Mumbai residence of Dr. B. R. Ambedkar and the organization founded by Raja Ram Mohan Roy in 1828. — Ans: Rajgriha in Dadar (Mumbai) and the Brahmo Sabha (1828).

Q4. Why did Jawaharlal Nehru call Jamsetji Tata a One-Man Planning Commission? — Ans: Because he pioneered India's core steel, hydroelectric power, and technical education institutions.

Memory Tip: Remember the 5 Pioneers in order — Jamsetji Tata (Industry) → Jyotirao Phule (Truth) → Savitribai Phule (Schools) → Ambedkar (Constitution) → Roy (Renaissance).